

Ideation Phase

Define the Problem Statements

Date	28 October 2026
Team ID	SWTID-2026-6819
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Project Name	Streamlining IT Procurement: Automating Standard Laptop Orders with Flow Designer
Maximum Marks	2 Marks

1. Problem Statement

In modern corporate and enterprise environments, efficient IT procurement is crucial for maintaining operational continuity and employee onboarding. However, the current IT procurement workflow for standard laptop requests suffers from significant operational bottlenecks:

1. **Manual Overhead & Delays:** Requests for standard laptops currently depend on manual intervention to review, triage, create tasks, and route requests to hardware engineers.
2. **Lack of Automated Task Assignment:** After a service request is approved, tasks are not automatically routed to the **Hardware** team, causing requests to sit idle in queue.
3. **Configuration Oversights:** Important setup steps (e.g., standard OS build, software provisioning) are prone to human oversight due to missing or inconsistent task short descriptions.
4. **SLA Violations & End-User Friction:** The cumulative delays lead to longer waiting times for end users, impacting productivity and increasing IT helpdesk ticket volume.

2. Project Vision & Objectives

The primary objective of this project is to implement an automated, low-code workflow using **ServiceNow Flow Designer** to streamline standard laptop procurement and hardware configuration.

Key Objectives:

- **Automate Task Generation:** Trigger an automatic Catalog Task (*sc_task*) generation immediately upon request approval.
- **Standardize Assignment Routing:** Automatically assign created tasks to the **Hardware** assignment group with predefined configurations.
- **Enforce Data Consistency:** Populate standard short descriptions (e.g., *"Laptop need to Configured"*) and field values dynamically to prevent human error.
- **Reduce Cycle Time:** Minimize user waiting time from order placement to final device deployment.

3. Scope of the Project

In-Scope:

- **Service Catalog Integration:** Binding the flow to the **Standard Laptop** item under the Hardware catalog.
- **Flow Designer Workflow:** Building a Flow named **Standard laptop task** in the Global application scope.
- **Trigger Setup:** Configuring the Service Catalog trigger in Flow Designer.
- **Catalog Task Action:** Auto-generating a Catalog Task linked to the Requested Item (**sc_req_item**) record.
- **Automated Data Population:**
 - Setting Assignment Group = **Hardware**
 - Setting Short Description = *"Laptop need to Configured"*
 - Setting Approval = **Approved**
- **End-to-End Testing:** Verification of request placement, approval status changes, and task creation in ServiceNow PDI.

Out-of-Scope:

- Physical hardware shipping and third-party logistics tracking.
- Integration with external vendor procurement APIs (e.g., Dell/HP ordering APIs).
- Custom JavaScript business rules or client scripts outside Flow Designer capabilities.

4. Expected Impact & Benefits

Area	Before Implementation	After Implementation
Task Creation	Manual creation by IT admin	100% Automated via Flow Designer
Task Routing	Manual selection of Hardware group	Auto-assigned to Hardware group
Data Quality	Inconsistent descriptions & details	Standardized Short Description automatically set
Processing Speed	Hours/Days delay after approval	Instantaneous task creation upon approval